

Clint Claessen

University of Freiburg, Seminar für Wissenschaftliche Politik, Belfortstraße 20, 79098 Freiburg im Breisgau, Germany

PERSONAL AND CONTACT DETAILS

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CURRENT POSITION

10/2026 - Present	Postdoctoral Researcher INCONEX ERC project, Seminar für Wissenschaftliche Politik, University of Freiburg, Germany
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EDUCATION

08/2020 - 06/2026	University of Basel, Switzerland PhD in Political Science <i>Summa Cum Laude</i>
01/2018	University of Amsterdam, Netherlands MSc in Teacher Training Social Studies <i>Cum Laude, GPA: 8.6 / 10</i>
01/2016	ETH Zurich, Switzerland MA in Comparative and International Studies <i>Insigni Cum Laude, GPA: 5.57 / 6.0</i>
07/2013	University of Amsterdam, Netherlands BSc in Political Science <i>Cum Laude with Honours, GPA: 8.6 / 10</i>

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC POSITIONS AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

06/2025 - 09/2026	Postdoctoral Researcher INCONEX ERC project, Salzburg Centre of European Union Studies (SCEUS), University of Salzburg, Austria
05/2022 - 08/2022	Visiting Scholar Department of Political Science, Carleton University, Ottawa, Canada
01/2022 - 04/2022	Visiting Scholar Data Science Institute, London School of Economics, United Kingdom
09/2021 - 12/2021	Visiting Scholar Data Science Lab, Hertie School, Berlin, Germany
01/2020 - 08/2020	Research Assistant , PCC Project University of Basel, Switzerland
04/2018 - 10/2019	Shift Supervisor , Starbucks - Britnell Books Toronto, Canada

01/2017 - 01/2018	High School Teacher , Social Studies Huizermaat, Huizen, The Netherlands
04/2015 - 02/2016	Research Assistant , Prof. Stefanie Bailer ETH Zurich, Switzerland
02/2015 - 06/2015	Teaching Assistant , Prof. Josette Bear University of Zurich, Switzerland

PUBLICATIONS IN PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

2026	Don't Look up: Evaluating the Tradeoff Between Performance and Sustainability of Text Classification Using Open LLMs, with <i>Sean Hamilton-Palicki</i> and <i>Isaac Bravo</i> . <i>Social Science Computer Review</i> , OnlineFirst. [link]
2026	Ambition and access: Linking regional opportunity structures and career-ambitious youth party members, with <i>Stefanie Bailer</i> and <i>Tamaki Ohmura</i> . <i>Party Politics</i> , OnlineFirst. [link]
2026	Moderation or Amplification? Mapping Speech Distinctiveness Among Green Parties Using a Machine Learning Approach, with <i>Denise Traber</i> and <i>Martijn Schoonvelde</i> . <i>Legislative Studies Quarterly</i> , 51(3). [link]
2025	Picture-perfect: The relationship between party leader visibility and voting during party leader elections, with <i>Maxime Walder</i> . Accepted at <i>Visual Communication Quarterly</i> .
2024	Accruing Career Capital: How Party Leaders with More Political Experience Survive Longer, <i>Party Politics</i> , 30(4): 719-735. [link]
2021	The Winners of Legislative Mandate: An Analysis of Post-Parliamentary Career Positions in Germany and the Netherlands, <i>European Journal of Political Research</i> , 60(1): 25-45, with Stefanie Bailer and Tomas Turner-Zwinkels. [link]

WORKING PAPERS

2025	Risen to the Top, but Put at a Disadvantage: Examining the Role of Career Capital in Gendered Party Leaders' Political Survival.
2025	Populist Leaders' Pragmatism: Investigating the Role of Party Leaders in Populist Rhetoric.

AWARDS

2018	National NVLM-Prize for Best Series of Lessons in Social Studies [link]
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RESEARCH AND TRAVELING GRANTS

50,400 CHF	Doc.Mobility for the project ' <i>Party Leaders' Pathways to Power</i> ' - Collecting and analyzing data on party leaders careers, September 2021 - August 2022, at various institutions, granted by the SNF
2,600 CHF	Travel Grant to present 'A Career Catalyst: Youth Wings and Party Leaders' Gendered Political Survival at the ECPR General Conference in Prague and the SISP in Genoa, by the FAG, Freiwillige Akademische Gesellschaft, 2023
1,500 CHF	Travel Grant to present 'At the Top against Odds: Career Capital in Gendered Party Leaders' Survival' at the American Political Science Conference in Philadelphia - by the FAG, Freiwillige Akademische Gesellschaft, 2024

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Reviewer	Journal of Politics, Comparative Political Studies, European Journal of Political Research, Party Politics, European Journal of Gender and Politics, European Union Politics, Swiss Political Science Review, Scandinavian Political Studies, Journal of Diversity and Gender Studies, Parliamentary Affairs, EPJ Data Science, Politics and Governance, Austrian Journal of Political Science, CPSS Conference 2024/2025
Representative Mittelbau	Representing non-professorial teaching staff, Department of Social Sciences, University of Basel, 2022-2025

INVITED TALKS AND INVITED WORKSHOPS

- Colloquium: Department of Political Science, University of Innsbruck on the 27th of January, 2026
- Workshop: Open-Source Large Language Models for Behavioral Science at the Faculty of Psychology, University of Basel on the 11th of February, 2025
- Workshop: Analysing Faces with Images as Data (online), scholars for Ukraine on the 25th of July, 2024
- Colloquium: Department of Political Science, University of Vienna on the 25th of March, 2024
- Workshop: Analysing Faces with Images as Data at COMPTTEXT 2023, Glasgow
- The Conference on Political Careers, at the University of Basel, in the panel 'Political Pathways' on June 20, 2022
- DSI Unstructured Data Session, at the London School of Economics, on the 14th of March, 2022
- Internal LSE Colloquium in London, at the Data Science Institute on the 16th of February, 2022
- CIVICA PhD Panel (online) on the 'Governance and Democracy in the Digital Era', on the 11th of October, 2021
- The Empirical Political Science in Progress (EPSIP) colloquium at the Humboldt University (online), on the 18th of November, 2021

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

EPSS	2026
EPSA	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
APSA	2022, 2024
CPSA	2022, 2024
ECPR Parl.	2016, 2021, 2023, 2025
ECPR General	2021, 2023, 2024, 2025
ECPR JS	2023
COMPTTEXT	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
SVPW	2020, 2023, 2024, 2026
AuPSA	2025
SISP	2023, 2024, 2026
PSAI	2021, 2025
GraPa	2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Supervision	10x Seminar Papers, University of Basel
Spring 2025 & 23/21	BA Seminar: From Party Members to Party Leaders: Selecting the Party Executive, University of Basel [<i>Evaluation 2025, 2023, 2021</i>]
Fall 2024	BA Course: Analyzing Politicians' Social Media with Data Science, University of Basel [<i>evaluation</i>]
Spring 2024	BA Seminar: The 2024 Presidential Election: An Introduction to US Political Parties and Their Candidate Selection Process, University of Basel [<i>evaluation</i>]
Fall 2023	BA Seminar: Unlocking Social Media: Investigating Image-based Political Communication during Elections through Applied Methods, University of Basel [<i>evaluation</i>]
Spring 2023	BA Seminar: From Party Members to Party Leaders: Selecting the Party Executive, University of Basel [<i>evaluation</i>]
Fall 2022	BA Seminar: Introduction to the Political System of the United States: The 2022 Midterm Elections, University of Basel [<i>evaluation</i>]
Fall 2020	BA Seminar: The 2020 Presidential Election: An Introduction to the United States and its Electoral Process, University of Basel [<i>evaluation</i>]
Spring 2015	MA Tutorial: Tutorial for Prof. J. Baer's Course: The Legitimizing of Empire. Nikolai Ia. Danilevskii's Russia and Europe, ETH Zurich

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Substantial

2021	Writing for Publication in the Social Sciences and Humanities, University of Basel
	<u>Advanced Methods</u>
2023	Visual Analysis, ECPR Winter School
2021	Natural Language Processing with Deep Learning, XCS224N, Stanford Online
2020	Regression Analysis II, Maximum Likelihood Estimation I and Mathematics for Social Scientists II, ICPSR Summer School
2020	Machine Learning, Text Analysis, ECPR Winter School

Academic Teaching and Learning

06/2023	Bystander Training, University of Basel
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PUBLIC OUTREACH: INTERVIEWS AND MEDIA CONTRIBUTIONS

Political Science Blog	Does political experience matter for the success of party leaders? <i>In: LSE EUROPP Blog, 5th of October, 2023</i>
	Is there really a revolving door between politics and business? (with Stefanie Bailer and Tomas Turner-Zwinkels) <i>In: LSE EUROPP Blog, 9th of June, 2020</i>
	De Parlementaire 'baantjescarrousel': feit of fictie? (with Stefanie Bailer and Tomas Turner-Zwinkels) <i>In: StukRoodVlees, 7th of April, 2020</i>

News/Radio	Rechtspopulist Geert Wilders gewinnt Wahlen in den Niederlanden <i>In: SRF 10-vor-10, Switzerland, 23rd of November, 2023</i> Koolmees naar NS: Bewijst dit het bestaan van een Haagse baantjescarousel? <i>In: Radio 1, The Netherlands, 11th of October, 2022</i> Angriff auf das 'Haus der Demokratie' <i>In: Telebasel, Switzerland, 7th of January, 2021</i>
Events	U.S. Election Night in Atlantis, Basel. <i>Co-Organizer</i> . See TeleBasel, Switzerland, 5th of November, 2024

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Dutch:	Native
English:	Fluent
German:	C2

COMPUTING SKILLS

Data Science:	R, Python
Other:	OBS, L ^A T _E X

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Stefanie Bailer	Professor of Comparative Politics Universität Basel Department of Political Science Bernoullistrasse 14/16, 4056 Basel, Switzerland Email: stefanie.bailer@unibas.ch Tel: +41 61 207 13 81
Prof. Dr. Denise Traber	Associate Professor of Political Sociology Universität Basel Department of Political Science Bernoullistrasse 14/16, 4056 Basel, Switzerland Email: denise.traber@unibas.ch Tel: +41 61 207 60 54
Prof. Dr. Ken Benoit	Dean of the School of Social Sciences and Professor of Computational Social Science Singapore Management University School of Social Sciences Singapore 179873 Email: kbenoit@smu.edu.sg
Prof. Dr. Martijn Schoonvelde	Assistant Professor of European Politics & Society University of Groningen Chair group Politics and Society Oude Kijk in 't Jatstraat 26, 9712 EK Groningen, Netherlands Email: martijn.schoonvelde@rug.nl

Last update: October 2026